

KDP Ebook Preflight Checklist

Everything to check before you upload a Kindle ebook — verified against KDP's official guidelines

BookKraft AI — bookkraftai.com

MANUSCRIPT & FILE

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ File is DOCX, EPUB, or KPF — not .pages or .odt | <i>KDP rejects unsupported formats at upload</i> |
| ☐ All tracked changes accepted and comments removed | <i>Stray edits convert into the ebook</i> |
| ☐ File is under 650 MB | <i>Compress images if larger</i> |
| ☐ No password protection on the file | <i>KDP cannot open encrypted files</i> |
| ☐ Double spaces removed — replace two spaces with one throughout | <i>A Word habit that survives conversion</i> |
| ☐ Straight quotes converted to curly consistently — no mix of both | <i>Or left straight per house style</i> |
| ☐ Encoding artifacts removed: □, mojibake (â€™), byte-order marks, zero-width spaces (U+200B) | <i>Save the source as UTF-8</i> |
| ☐ Empty paragraph tags deleted — space with CSS margins, not blank <p> lines | <i>Blank paragraphs render as ghost gaps</i> |

STRUCTURE & NAVIGATION

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Chapter titles styled as Heading 1 consistently | <i>Required for the table of contents to build</i> |
| ☐ Logical table of contents generated from headings, not typed by hand | <i>Manual TOCs break when content reflows</i> |
| ☐ nav.xhtml present with a valid <nav epub:type="toc"> element (EPUB 3) | <i>Modern navigation document</i> |
| ☐ toc.ncx present and referenced in the OPF manifest | <i>Backward-compatible navigation</i> |
| ☐ OPF spine lists every chapter in reading order, no duplicate idrefs | <i>Wrong order confuses e-reader navigation</i> |
| ☐ Every manifest file exists in the package; nothing in the package is undeclared | <i>Mismatches fail validation</i> |

Free EPUB Validator & Metadata Builder at bookkraftai.com — no signup needed

METADATA

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|--|
| ☐ | dc:title populated and matching the cover exactly | KDP flags mismatches |
| ☐ | dc:creator set to the author name, matching your Amazon Author Page | Consolidates your author profile |
| ☐ | dc:language set to a valid BCP 47 code (e.g. en or en-US) | |
| ☐ | dc:identifier present — a valid ISBN-13 or a unique UUID | Required in content.opf |
| ☐ | Book description is 4,000 characters or fewer | KDP hard limit, HTML tags counted |
| ☐ | 7 keyword fields filled with long-tail phrases readers search | 2–3 word phrases work best; don't repeat title words |
| ☐ | 3 categories chosen at the most specific subcategory available | KDP allows up to three |
| ☐ | AI-generated text, images, or translations disclosed at publish | AI-assisted editing does not require disclosure |

COVER & IMAGES

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|--|
| ☐ | Cover ideally 1,600 × 2,560 px (width × height), ideal ratio 1.6:1 | Minimum 625 × 1,000 px |
| ☐ | Cover in RGB, saved as JPEG or TIFF, under 50 MB | Not CMYK |
| ☐ | Embedded images are JPG, PNG, or GIF — no EMF, WMF, BMP, or TIFF inside the EPUB | Windows-only formats fail |
| ☐ | Images at least 300 PPI, with MIME types declared in the manifest | Low-res images look blurry on HD screens |

VALIDATION & PREVIEW

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|--|
| ☐ | EPUB passes EPUBCheck (current version) with zero Error or Fatal issues | Free BookKraft EPUB Validator — no login |
| ☐ | No broken internal links or missing anchor targets | Common cause of KDP review rejection |
| ☐ | Previewed in Kindle Previewer across Fire, Paperwhite, and phone | Simulates the real Kindle conversion |
| ☐ | Enhanced Typesetting renders correctly — justified text, drop caps, images | Most readers use this mode |

PRICING & SETUP

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|--------------------------|---|--|
| ☐ | 70% royalty list price set within \$2.99–\$12.99 on Amazon.com | Band widened from \$9.99 in July 2026 |
| ☐ | KDP Select enrollment decided — 90-day Kindle exclusivity tradeoff understood | No other ebook store while enrolled |
| ☐ | Territory rights set to your actual scope | Worldwide only if you hold global rights |
| ☐ | First 10% (the Look Inside sample) opens strong | Amazon shows the first 10% free |
| ☐ | Copyright page includes year, author name, and a rights statement | Standard front matter |